



'WHAT ENDURES IS THE ABILITY TO CONTRIBUTE'

Kris Gopalakrishnan

► **WITH THE INTENSITY** of corporate leadership behind him, Kris Gopalakrishnan says life opened more space for reflection, reading, and deliberate engagement with ideas.

"I would describe it as moving from a phase of intense execution to one of considered engagement," he says. "The sense of responsibility does not disappear. It simply becomes more self-directed. What endures is not the designation," he reflects.

Over time, his long-standing interests in technology, science, research, and education became the focus of his post-CEO life through deeper engagement with institutions such as Indian Institute of Technology, Madras and Indian Institute of Science (IISc).

"One consistent thread across my journey has been institution building," he says. "At Infosys, it was about creating a global organisation anchored in strong values. In this phase, that orientation continues through a more diverse set of engagements."

Technology remains central to his work, particularly AI and its implications for society and the future of work. Through Axilor Ventures, he works closely with entrepreneurs and early-stage innovation, while Pratiksha Trust and the Centre for Brain Research at IISc support long-term scientific and medical research.

Another issue that increasingly occupies his attention is ageing and India's rapidly growing senior population. "India is still perceived as a young country," he says. "But in absolute terms, the number of senior citizens is rising rapidly."

That concern eventually led to Vayah Vikas, a not-for-profit initiative focused on active ageing and

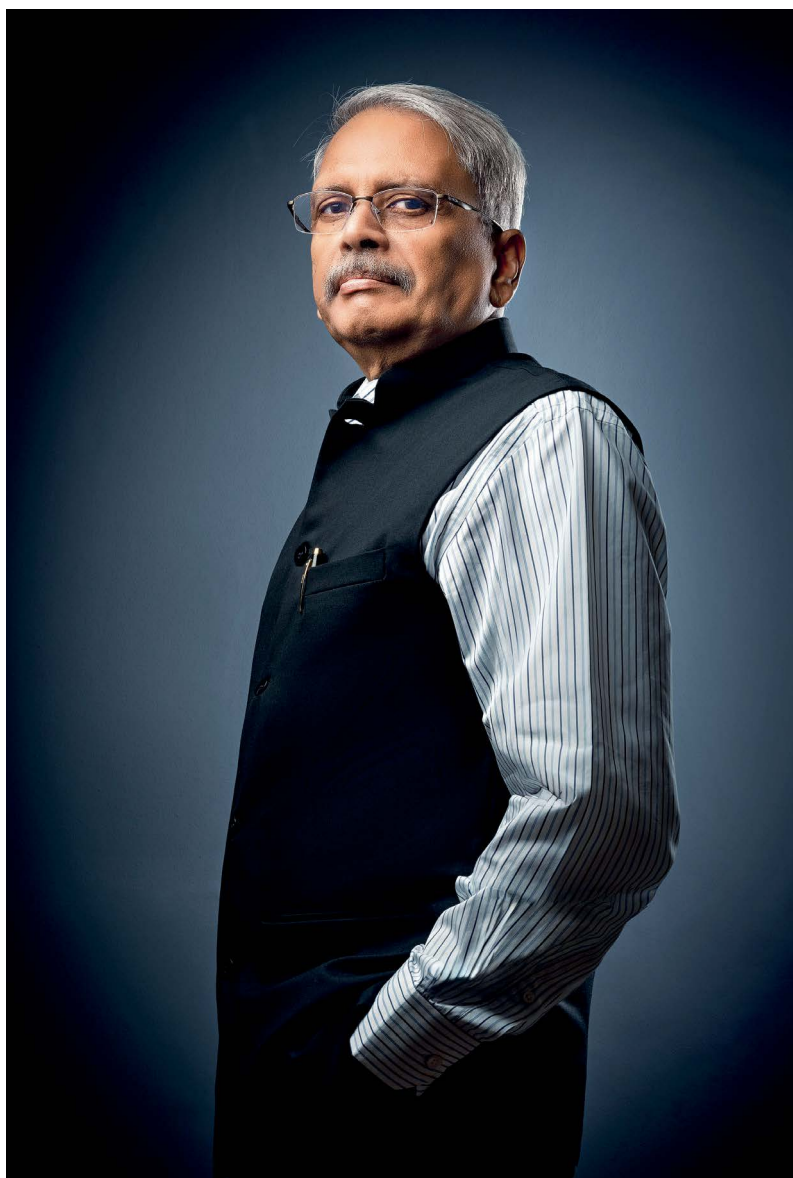


PHOTO BY **BANDEEP SINGH**

meaningful participation for seniors, which today reaches over 1,80,000 members across three states.

"The idea is to enable seniors to remain physically active, socially connected, and intellectually engaged," he says. "Seniors are contributors with accumulated wisdom and experience, and that potential should not be framed only in terms of dependency." The transition has also allowed Gopalakrishnan to invest more deeply in personal interests that operating leadership often leaves little room for. He is now more regular with physical fitness and has incorporated yoga into his daily routine.

"I also travel more, not just for work, but to explore, experience different cultures, and enjoy the world a little more deliberately."

According to him, there is now the freedom to align time with one's values and interests. "That balance is deeply satisfying."